

State Facts

Abbreviation: KS

Capital: Topeka

Nickname: The Sunflower State

Statehood: 1861, 34th state

Population: 2.9 million people

State flower: wild sunflower

State bird: western meadowlark

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Kansas

The classic film *The Wizard of Oz* is set in Kansas for good reason—Kansas is a prime location for tornadoes. The state has also produced groundbreakers such as the brave pilot Amelia Earhart and George Washington Carver, a renowned scientist and inventor.

*Sunflower field
in Kansas*

Pteranodon

*Kansas has an
official state flying
fossil. It's the
pteranodon.*